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Your 21-Day Social Pattern Calendar

LB

Your eating is externally regulated - the offer, the absence, the person you love with a plate. Not hunger. Pattern.

.....

begin here

day

SHIFT 1

The food was offered.

1

day

Did you eat today because you were hungry?

2

day

Notice what made it hard to say no.

3

day

Whose appetite are you following?

4

day

SHIFT 2

You stayed. The food was optional.

5

day

No one was there. Notice how the meal started.

6

day

The relationship and the food are not the same thing.

7

day

The belonging was already there.

8

day

You did not need the refill to stay.

9

day

SHIFT 3

You decided before you arrived.

10

day

You initiated the meal. Note that.

11

day

You said thank you. You did not have to eat it.

12

day

The table was yours to design.

13

day

One decision held the evening.

14

day

The prompt came from inside today.

15

day

The love was in the offering. Not in the eating.

16

day

SHIFT 4

The pattern is predictable now.

17

day

You know when you need a prompt and when you do not.

18

day

You can be close to someone and still know what you need.

19

day

You moved through it. Note that.

20

day

The pattern is now yours.

21

HOW TO USE

Laminate or slip into a sheet protector with a dry-erase marker. Write the day of the week in each small square. Erase and reuse any time.

CLEAN COPY



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Social Pattern Cue Key

Use this side when a calendar phrase needs a reminder. These cues are reminders of what you already know.

SHIFT 1

The food was offered.

The Social pattern begins with an offer, not a craving. Someone handed you something, passed the basket, or poured the glass. The eating started there, not in your body.

Did you eat today because you were hungry?

For some Social pattern presentations, eating disappears when no external prompt exists. If the first meal today happened because someone reminded you, cooked for you, or set a table - that is the pattern running in the other direction.

Notice what made it hard to say no.

When food comes from someone you care about, refusal can feel like rejection. The difficulty is not about the food. It is about what saying no means in that relationship.

Whose appetite are you following?

When you eat because the table is eating, you are following someone else's hunger. When you eat because someone offered and you did not want to disappoint them, you are following their care. Recognizing whose appetite is driving yours is the whole intervention.

SHIFT 2

You stayed. The food was optional.

You can remain at the table, in the conversation, fully present - without continuing to eat. Staying is the social act. The food is not required to prove it.

No one was there. Notice how the meal started.

If the meal happened without a prompt today - if hunger initiated it rather than a person, a schedule, or an occasion - note that. It is evidence that internal regulation is possible. If the meal did not happen until someone reminded you, that is also data.

The relationship and the food are not the same thing.

Accepting food from someone you love and accepting their love are not the same act. You can receive one without the other. The care that was in the offering does not disappear when you decline the plate.

The belonging was already there.

You were invited because of who you are. The table wanted you there before the food arrived. Eating everything offered does not deepen that.

You did not need the refill to stay.

A second helping is not a social obligation. Declining warmly, once, without explanation, is enough. The conversation continues either way.

SHIFT 3

You decided before you arrived.

The decision made before the food appears is worth ten decisions made at the table. The window for a clean choice closes when the plates come out.

You initiated the meal. Note that.

If hunger moved you toward food today - without a prompt, without someone else starting it - that is internal regulation. It is the pattern running differently. Note it specifically.

You said thank you. You did not have to eat it.

Receiving an offer graciously and declining it are not mutually exclusive. Thank you can be complete without a plate. The person offering wanted to give something. You received it in the way that worked for you.

The table was yours to design.

When the environment is yours, the food you serve is the food available. A table full of things you feel good about removes the negotiation entirely.

One decision held the evening.

A single pre-commitment made before you walked in held longer than ten decisions made under pressure.

The prompt came from inside today.

Hunger initiated the meal today, not a person or occasion. That is worth noting. The pattern is not fixed - it is responsive to conditions. When conditions support internal regulation, it happens.

The love was in the offering. Not in the eating.

The person who cooked for you, brought you something, or set a place for you was expressing care. That care was complete at the moment of offering. Eating to honor it is the pattern mistaking the gesture for the requirement.

SHIFT 4

The pattern is predictable now.

You have seen enough of your own data to know which tables are hardest, which people, which conditions. Predictability is a map.

You know when you need a prompt and when you do not.

Some days you eat because hunger moves you. Some days you eat because someone else started it. Knowing which is which - and on which days you need the external structure - is the pattern understood.

You can be close to someone and still know what you need.

Intimacy does not require eating what someone offers. You can love the person, receive the gesture, and still make a different choice. Those things are not in conflict.

You moved through it. Note that.

A social event, a family meal, a moment of offered food that went differently than it used to - note it. You were present. The pattern did not run you. That happened.

The pattern is now yours.

You understand what drives it - the crowd, the absence, the person you love with a plate in their hand. The pattern does not run you. You run the pattern.